Juan David Garcia-Gonzalez

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Research interests

Education, Migration, Conflict, Innovation

Affiliations

2022 – Present **PhD Candidate**, Bocconi University – Milan, Italy
2023 – Present Adjunct Lecturer of Economics, Universidad de la Sabana – Colombia
2024 – Present Research Fellow, Universidad del Rosario – Colombia
2025 – Present Youth Member, Academia Colombiana de Ciencias Económicas – Colombia
2025 – Present Member, The Regional Studies Association (RSA)
2022 – Present Member, YSI INET

Education

2022 – Present **Bocconi University** – Milan, Italy
Ph.D. in Social and Political Science
Teaching Assistant & Research Assistant at DONDENA
Visiting Fellow at The University of Melbourne and Universidad del Rosario

2019 – 2020 **University College London (UCL IIPP)** – London, UK
MPA in Innovation, Public Policy and Public Value, with Distinction

2019 – 2021 **Massachusetts Institute of Technology (MIT) & J-PAL** – Online
MicroMasters in Data, Economics, and Design of Policy: International Development

2016 – 2017 **Universidad de Almería** – Almeria, Spain
M.Sc. in Local Sustainable Development, with Honours (best graduate and thesis)

2011 – 2016 **Universidad Nacional de Colombia** – Bogota, Colombia
Bachelor in Economics, top 10% of class

Working papers and work in progress

[4] Higher Education and Migration: Quasi-experimental evidence from the Colombian peace agreement
Draft available upon request
Funded by ICFES – Instituto Colombiano para la Evaluación de la Educación

[3] Higher Education and Migration under Conflict: A lab-in-the-field experiment in Colombia *(design)*

[2] Career Mentoring for Underrepresented Talent: effects on education, employment and innovation
with A. de Gendre and N. Salamanca
OSF PAP, Draft available upon request
Funded by The University of Melbourne Research Partnership Fund

[1] Brain Drain, Brain Gain and International Scholarships: the educational, labor, and innovation outcomes of Colfuturo *(analyzing data)*
with A. de Gendre and N. Salamanca
Funded by The University of Melbourne Research Partnership Fund

Funding, Awards, and Fellowships

2025 External Investigator, "Postgraduate loan-scholarships effects on labor and scientific outcomes," **The University of Melbourne Research Partnership Fund**, AUD 47,800 (~33,000 USD)

2025 Principal Investigator, "Peace and Academic Migration," **ICFES Research call**, COP 16,000,000 (~4,000 USD)

2019 – 2026 Fellow, São Paulo School of Advanced Science, **Fapesp**

2022 Full Merit PhD Fellowship, **Bocconi University**

2021 2071 Moonshot Apprenticeship Program, **UAE Ministry of Cabinet Affairs**

2019 Master's degree scholarships, **UCL Bartlett and Colfuturo**

2018 Grant for Youth Peace Initiative, **Ministry of Foreign Affairs of the Netherlands**

2017 Mobility Grant for International Visiting Scholar, **AUIP**

2016 Master's degree scholarships Scholarship, **AUIP and Universidad de Almería**

Invited Seminars, Workshops and Conferences

2026 *(Including scheduled)* Congreso Anual de la Red de Investigadores de Economia, BanRep & UniEIA (*December*); LAPolMeth, UniAndes (*November*); YSI Economics of Innovation Working Group Workshop, TalTech; Summer School on Socioeconomic Opportunity and Inequality, Icesi, Georgetown Uni & UChicago; São Paulo School of Advanced Science on Immigration, Environmental Violence and Colonialism, USP; Summer School on Socioeconomic Opportunity and Inequality, Bocconi, ISPI & UChicago; Food for thought - F4T, Bocconi; UZH-Bocconi PhD workshop, Bocconi; IZA@LISER Summer School in Labor Economics 2026, LISER; KIRDSA III International Conference on Regional Development in South America, UNSAM; The Geography of Innovation Winter School, U Pavia; ALP-POP 2026, Bocconi

2025 Ceremonia de Ingreso a la Academia Colombiana de Ciencias Económicas Joven, ACCE; Twice - Melbourne Institute of Applied Economic and Social Research Brown Bag, U Melbourne; Network Economics Conference and Summer School 2025, Monash University; 4th Summer School on the "Economics of Migration", University of California and UC Davis; Bogotá Summer School of Economics - Network Theory in Economics, U Andes; Seminario Banco de la República, BanRep; Seminario CID, UNAL; Microeconomics Workshop, U Rosario; São Paulo School of Advanced Science on High Dimensional Modelling, FGV; PhD seminar - La Strada, Bocconi; LEAP Lunch seminar, Bocconi; Seminar ERC POPCLIMA, U Bologna

2024 UCL IIPP Seminar, UCL; P&I Clinic Seminar, Bocconi; Congreso de Economía Colombiana, U Andes; PhD seminar - La Strada, Bocconi; São Paulo School of Advanced Science on Technology and Innovation Strategies and Policies for Economic Development, Unicamp; IRSPM; U Tampere

2023 CEU 18th Annual Doctoral Conference, CEU; Bogotá Summer School of Economics - Research on STEM, U Javeriana

Teaching experience

Universidad de la Sabana, Colombia

2024 – Present Main instructor, Development Economics; 256 hours, 92 students & 7 TAs (4.7/5)

2023 – 2025 Main instructor, Economic Policy (*In spanish*); 240 hours, 100 students & 6 TAs (4.7/5)

2019 Main instructor, History of Economic Thought (*In spanish*); 48 hours & 17 students (4.8/5)

2018 – 2019 Main instructor, World Economic History (*In spanish*); 96 hours & 62 students (4.7/5)

Bocconi University, Italy

2023 – 2024 Teaching Assistant, Applications for Management; 20 hours

Universidad de Almeria, Spain

2017 Main instructor, Publishing in Social Sciences (*In spanish*); 29 hours & 15 students

Publications (Pre-PhD)

[5] García-González, J. D., Pires Manso, J. R., García, J. M., & Valenciano, J. P. (2024). Size of government and economic growth: A convergence analysis of former Soviet Union countries from 1991 to 2018. **Amfiteatru Economic**, 26(18), 1256–1269.

[4] González, G. H., García-González, J. D., Gómez-Medina, J. S., & Corbella, V. I. (2023). Regionalization of Latin America based on asymmetries in the absorptive capacity of countries. **The Journal of Economic Asymmetries**, 27, e00291.

[3] García-González, J. D., & Skrita, A. (2019). Predicting academic performance based on student's family environment: Evidence for Colombia using classification trees. **Psychology, Society & Education**, 11(3), 299–311.

[2] Sáenz-Castro, J. E., & García-González, J. D. (2019). The relationship between corruption and inequality in Colombia: Empirical evidence using panel data for the period 2008–2017. **Iberoamerican Journal of Development Studies**, 8(2), 28–43.

[1] Díaz Pinzón, B. H., Gómez Medina, J. S., García-González, J. D., Melo Román, H. A., & Sanabria, F. E. (2017). Contribución de las iniciativas de tecnologías de la información en las organizaciones: Una revisión de la literatura. **Innovar, 27**(66), 41–55.

Research and Industry Experience

2023 – 2024 **Research Assistant**, DONDENA - Bocconi University, Italy

2021 – 2022 **Advisor**, Colombian Ministry of Housing and Cities, Colombia

2021 **Consultant**, Universidad Nacional de Colombia, Colombia

2021 **Apprentice**, Mohammed Bin Rashid Centre for Government Innovation, UAE

2021 **Consultant**, Berg Institute, Colombia

2020 **Researcher**, University College London IIPP, UK

2020 **Consultant**, Fedesarrollo, Colombia

2017 – 2018 **Young Professional**, Telefónica, Colombia

2015 – 2016 **Research Assistant**, Academia Colombiana de Ciencias Económicas, Colombia

Service

Referee *World Development, Cuadernos de Economía, Revista Equidad & Desarrollo*

Advising and Mentoring

Advisor Master's thesis advisor; Andres Felipe Naranjo, U Externado (2025)

Research Internship Carolina Tamayo, U Sabana (2025-2026); Ian Otero, U Sabana (2025-2026); Isabella Valencia, U Sabana (2025); Juanita Suárez, U Sabana (2025)

Technical skills

Software

LaTeX, R, STATA

Languages

Spanish (Native), English (Fluent), Italian (Fluent)